

- O -

odometer – the device on the instrument panel indicating the total number of miles the vehicle has been driven

over driving headlights – driving at a speed making your stopping distance longer than the distance lighted by your headlights; low beams are limited to 45 mph and high beams are limited to 65 mph for stopping purposes

oversteer – when the rear tire patches lose varying degrees of traction and the front tire patches have more traction causing a spinning effect (yaw) around the vehicle's center of gravity. The vehicle has a tendency to spin to the left or right even though the driver is not turning the steering wheel

overtake – to pass the vehicle ahead

over-the-counter medicine – drug that can be obtained legally without a doctor's prescription

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parallel parking – the vehicle lines up parallel or going the same direction as the curb. When parallel parking, the vehicle must be 6 to 18 inches from the curb

passive restraint device – a restraint device, such as an airbag or an automatic safety belt, that works without the passenger or driver initiating the device

pedestrian – a person on foot

pedestrian signal – a signal used at traffic intersections that indicates when a person should walk or wait

peer pressure – mental and social influence of others of a similar age on decision-making skills

perception distance – the distance your vehicle travels during perception time

perception time – the length of time it takes for the driver to make a risk-reduction decision

peripheral vision – the area a person can see that is around the central field of vision

perpendicular parking – the vehicle is parked at a right angle to a curb or parking stripe using visual reference points for entering and leaving

prescription medicine – drug that can be purchased legally only when ordered by a doctor

preventive maintenance – routine care and attention to your vehicle

property-damage insurance – protects the driver who is at fault against claims for damages to another person's property, up to specified limits

protected left turn – left turn made on a left-turn, green arrow, or delayed green light while oncoming traffic is stopped

protective gear – the items a motorcyclist wears to protect head, eyes, and body

- Q -**- R -**

race – the use of one or more vehicles in an attempt to:

1. Out gain or outdistance another vehicle or prevent another vehicle from passing;
2. Arrive at a given destination ahead of another vehicle(s); or
3. Test the physical stamina or endurance of an operator over a long-distance driving route

reaction distance – the distance a vehicle travels from the point the driver perceives the need to act and the point where the driver takes action through braking, steering, or acceleration. Distance your vehicle travels until the driver perceives the need to change speed or position

reaction time – the time the vehicle travels from the point the driver perceives the need to act and the point where the driver takes the action through braking, steering, or acceleration. Length of time it takes the driver to execute a reduced-risk action, after a response is perceived by the driver

reduced visibility – the inability of a driver to see clearly

reference point – a part of the outside or inside of a vehicle, as viewed from the driver's seat, that relates to some part of the road which allows the driver to estimate position on the road. The road positions (points of reference) of the vehicle assist the driver in determining when to start turning, vehicle limitations, or where the vehicle is actually located

regulatory sign – a sign controlling traffic

restraint device – any part of a vehicle holding an occupant in the seat during a collision

restricted interlock license – authorizes an individual to operate a motor vehicle equipped with an ignition interlock device